STERLING ROW

Content Machine

Five formats. Twenty explainers with scripts, twenty movie edits, lifestyle montages, slideshows and The Brief.

Version 1 | Working draft | Palette: Midnight & Cognac | "Adapt or Perish" | "The House always wins"

Read this first

- Scripts are first drafts written from general knowledge. They have NOT been checked against sources. Each idea has a fact-check list. Verify every name, date and number before you record.
- Where I describe a movie or series scene, I am going from memory. Find the scene yourself and confirm it is the one I mean.
- Real people appear in these scripts. Keep to documented facts (court findings, filings, reputable reporting). If a claim cannot be sourced, cut it.
- Nothing here has been recorded, edited or published yet.

Contents

- 1. Explainer videos: 20 ideas, what each needs, and a full script
- 2. Movie edits: clip library and 20 edit plans (two types)
- 3. Lifestyle montages: concepts and how to get the clips
- 4. Slideshows: spec, themes and the image workflow
- 5. The Brief (proposed fifth format)
- 6. Fonts, licences and technical specs
- 7. Asset checklist and how to send me files

How assets work

Cut-out images: can I get them myself?

Yes, for stills. I can download images from the internet in this environment and remove the backgrounds myself, so you do not have to. The limits are legal rather than technical:

- Best source: Wikimedia Commons and similar. Many portraits are free to reuse, but each has its own licence (some need credit in the caption). I will log the licence and author of every image I use.
- Press kits (company media pages) are usually fine for editorial use. I will note the page.
- News agency photos (Getty, Reuters, AP) and most Google Images results are copyrighted. I will avoid them unless you have a licence. Using them is a real risk once the account grows.
- Public-domain archive photos (for example Rockefeller, old Wall Street) are safe.
- If I cannot find a free-licensed cut-out of a person, I will tell you and propose a stylised alternative (silhouette, illustration, newspaper-clipping treatment).

Video clips: what I can and cannot do

- I cannot take video from streaming services or rip copyrighted films and TV from YouTube. You collect the clips (download, screen-record or save) and give them to me.
- Once you share them, I can trim, caption, crop, build montages, add the text styling and export to 1080x1920.
- Interview and news clips used in explainers are also copyrighted. Keep each clip short, add your own narration, and expect the occasional takedown.
- Free stock video I can fetch myself: Pexels, Pixabay, Coverr, Mixkit (check each licence).

Google Drive: how to send me big files

- I do have a Google Drive connector in this session. It is linked to your waykongroup.com work account, not the new brand Gmail. I will only open files or folders you point me to.
- Easiest route: create a folder called SR_Footage in that Drive and share the link (or tell me the folder name). Use sub-folders: Explainers, Movie_Edits, Lifestyle, Audio_Not_Needed.
- I have not tested downloading large videos from Drive. Start with one small test clip (under about 50 MB). If big files fail, compress them to 720p first or upload them to this chat as a zip, as you did with the images.
- Name files plainly, for example succession_logan_not_serious_people.mp4, and tell me the exact timestamp you want in the edit.

Section 1: Explainer videos

Format: narrated story, 45 to 70 seconds, word-by-word captions, a new shot every 1 to 3 seconds. You generate the voiceover in ElevenLabs from the script; I build the edit.

How the structure works (from the Ackman reference)

Beat	Time	What is on screen
Cold open	0-3s	A striking image and half a sentence. No intro, no logo.
Name drop	3-8s	Subject appears. Caption lands on the name, in a bigger size.
Proof	8-15s	Reputation: a logo, a headline, a number.
Context	15-30s	Archive shots, charts, location B-roll.
Conflict / turn	30-50s	Interview clips, dramatic zooms, one pop-culture insert.
Payoff	50-65s	The lesson, in a short line. Slower cut, bigger text.
End card	65-70s	Sterling Row logo on Midnight, "Adapt or Perish".

Text and effects recipe

- Captions: one or two words at a time, centred low, white, Svenings. Key words in a larger size or cognac (#8A4B2D).
- Frames: a small clip floating on white; a full-bleed clip; a cut-out of the subject with tilted screenshots drifting around.
- Transitions (used sparingly): pixelate flash, glitch blocks, a colour flood for emphasis, a quick zoom. About 1 cut per 0.7 to 3 seconds.
- Pop-culture insert: one 1-2 second clip as a punchline, never more.

What I need for every explainer

- The voiceover audio from ElevenLabs (mp3 or wav), and the exact script it was read from.
- Word-level timing if ElevenLabs gives it (or I can estimate from the audio file; this is less accurate).
- The video files listed under each idea, in the Drive folder, named plainly.
- The standard end card (I will make it from the final logo).

1. Bill Ackman vs Carl Icahn: the Herbalife war

Pillar: Business and Power | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 177

WHAT I NEED

- Interview / talking-head clips of Ackman (podcasts, conferences) and of Icahn. 6-10 short clips, any length, I will pick the moments.
- The CNBC Ackman-Icahn on-air clash, as a clip.
- Stills and cut-outs of both men: I source from Wikimedia Commons / press kits and remove the backgrounds.
- B-roll: Wall Street signage, stock tickers, Herbalife products or stores.
- Pop-culture insert: a Wolf of Wall Street office shout.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Date and size of Ackman's short (Dec 2012, about $1bn).
- Icahn's stake and the on-air clash date (Jan 2013).
- FTC settlement (2016, about $200m) and what it did and did not say.
- When and how Ackman exited (2018) and the reported loss.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In December 2012, Bill Ackman stood in front of a room and told Wall Street that a company was a fraud. The company was Herbalife. He called it a pyramid scheme, and he'd bet one billion dollars that its stock would collapse.

Then Carl Icahn walked in.

Icahn had been a corporate raider since the eighties. He bought a huge stake in Herbalife. If Ackman was right, Icahn lost. If Icahn was right, Ackman lost.

Weeks later, they went at each other live on CNBC. Wall Street could not look away.

For years, the stock refused to fall. In 2016, regulators fined Herbalife two hundred million dollars and forced changes, but they never called it a pyramid scheme. Ackman closed the trade in 2018, reportedly at a heavy loss.

Ackman wasn't stupid. He just learned the hardest rule in markets. Being right isn't enough. The market can stay irrational longer than you can stay solvent. And when the other side has as much money as you, it stops being about the facts. It's about who blinks first.

2. Alexandr Wang: the 19-year-old who sold the shovels (Scale AI)

Pillar: Ambition and People | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 151

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Alexandr Wang (podcasts, talks, TV).
- Stills / cut-outs of Wang, plus the Scale AI logo for the end card.
- Footage of self-driving cars, data labelling, AI chat interfaces, Meta HQ (stock or your own).
- Graphic: valuation timeline (I build it).
- A talking-head clip of Zuckerberg, optional.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Wang's age and year of leaving MIT.
- Scale's valuation history ($7.3bn in 2021).
- Meta's June 2025 investment: amount, percentage, Wang's new role.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

At nineteen, Alexandr Wang dropped out of MIT. In 2016 he started a company called Scale AI.

What it does is not glamorous. Humans label data so that AI can learn from it. A self-driving car has to be shown thousands of images before it understands what a pedestrian is.

That boring job became essential. Self-driving companies hired Scale. Then the US military. Then the labs building the chatbots everyone talks about. By 2021, the company was valued at around seven billion dollars, and Wang was one of the youngest self-made billionaires on earth.

Then, in June 2025, Meta invested roughly fourteen billion dollars for a 49 percent stake and brought Wang in to lead its AI push.

Everyone wanted to find the gold. Wang sold the shovels.

So when a whole industry is chasing the same boom, ask one question. What does every single one of them have to buy?

3. NVIDIA: the Denny's bet

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 155

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Jensen Huang (keynotes in the leather jacket, interviews).
- Footage of video games, GPUs, server rooms, data centres.
- Stills / cut-outs: Huang, the three founders if available.
- Graphic: market-cap timeline (I build it).
- Pop-culture insert: a gaming clip.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Founding year (1993), founders, and the Denny's story.
- How close the early company came to failing, per Huang's own account.
- CUDA launch (2006) and the market-cap milestones ($1tn, $4tn, $5tn) with dates.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 1993, three engineers sat in a Denny's in San Jose and started a company to build graphics chips for video games. One of them was Jensen Huang.

It nearly ended early. Their first chip didn't sell, and by Huang's own telling, the company came close to running out of money.

They survived, and then they did something odd. In 2006, they released CUDA, software that let ordinary programmers use those gaming chips for any heavy computing job. For years, Wall Street shrugged. It looked like a very expensive distraction.

Then deep learning took off. Training an AI needed exactly what Nvidia had been building for a decade.

In 2023, Nvidia passed a trillion dollars in value. By 2025, it had passed four, and later five.

The bet looked wrong for ten years. That's the part nobody posts about. The advantage you build while nobody's watching is the only one nobody can copy by Friday.

4. Sam Altman: fired on a Friday, back by Wednesday

Pillar: Ambition and People | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 135

WHAT I NEED

- Interview / testimony clips of Sam Altman.
- Stills / cut-outs of Altman; OpenAI logo; news headlines from Nov 2023.
- Footage of ChatGPT in use, screen recordings.
- Pop-culture insert: a Succession boardroom clip.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Loopt: founded age 19, sold 2012 (about $43m).
- Y Combinator presidency (2014) and OpenAI founding (2015).
- The November 2023 firing and reinstatement dates.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

Sam Altman started his first company at nineteen. He dropped out of Stanford to do it. The company, Loopt, sold in 2012 for about forty-three million dollars. Not a failure. Not a hit.

At twenty-eight, he was running Y Combinator, the startup factory behind Airbnb and Stripe. In 2015, he co-founded OpenAI, a nonprofit built to make sure artificial intelligence didn't end badly.

In November 2022, it released ChatGPT. Within months, it was one of the fastest-growing products in history.

A year later, on a Friday in November 2023, OpenAI's board fired him. Days later, nearly every employee threatened to walk out. By the following Wednesday, he was back as CEO.

The board had the title. Altman had the people.

Power isn't the position on the chart. It's who follows you when the chart disappears.

5. Elon Musk in 2008: both companies, days from dead

Pillar: Ambition and People | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 134

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Musk talking about 2008.
- Falcon 1 launch footage (SpaceX publishes its own).
- Stills / cut-outs of Musk and the early Tesla Roadster.
- Pop-culture insert: a falling-from-a-height clip.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Number of failed Falcon 1 launches before success (three).
- Date of the successful fourth launch (28 Sept 2008).
- NASA contract date and value (Dec 2008, about $1.6bn).
- Tesla's last-minute funding round (late Dec 2008).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

2008. Elon Musk is running two companies, and both are about to die.

Tesla is nearly out of cash. SpaceX has launched three rockets, and all three have failed. If a fourth fails, it's over. He had already put in most of the money he'd made from PayPal.

On September 28th, the fourth Falcon 1 reached orbit.

Three months later, just before Christmas, NASA awarded SpaceX a contract worth about one point six billion dollars. Within days, Tesla closed a funding round it needed to survive.

Not weeks to spare. Days.

Today, one of those companies launches most of the rockets in the world, and the other makes some of the best-selling cars.

Every success story has a chapter where it almost didn't happen. You just never see that chapter on the highlight reel.

6. Jeff Bezos and the regret test

Pillar: Ambition and People | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 168

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Bezos (the regret-minimisation story, Amazon's early days).
- Stills of the garage origin, early website screenshots (archived), Bezos cut-outs.
- Footage of warehouses, delivery vans, data centres.
- Graphic: Amazon's early losses vs later revenue (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The hedge fund (D. E. Shaw) and the 'regret minimisation' framework.
- Amazon's incorporation (1994) and launch (1995).
- AWS launch (2006).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 1994, Jeff Bezos had the job most people dream of. He was a vice president at a New York hedge fund.

Then he read that the internet was growing at an unbelievable rate. He wanted to sell books online. His boss told him it was a great idea, for someone who didn't already have a great job.

So Bezos used a test. Picture yourself at eighty. Which choice will you regret? He knew he wouldn't regret trying, even if he failed. He would regret not trying.

He quit, drove west, and started Amazon in a rented garage in Washington.

For years, it lost money. Critics called it a fad. Then, in 2006, Amazon began renting out its computing power. That business, AWS, became one of the most profitable parts of the company.

The idea wasn't books. The idea was to build the infrastructure first, and let everyone else pay to use it.

You will rarely regret the risk you took. You will remember the one you didn't.

7. Warren Buffett and the failing textile mill

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 143

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Buffett (shareholder meetings, CNBC).
- Stills / cut-outs of Buffett and old Berkshire mill photos.
- Footage of Omaha, See's Candies, GEICO, Coca-Cola.
- Graphic: Berkshire vs S&P growth (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Buffett's first stock purchase age (11).
- Berkshire's textile origins and Buffett's own comments on the mistake.
- Long-term annual return vs the S&P 500 (cite Berkshire's letter, exact years).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

Warren Buffett bought his first stock at eleven years old.

Years later, he bought control of a failing New England textile company called Berkshire Hathaway. He's since called it one of his worst deals. The mills were dying.

But he noticed something. He didn't need the mills. He needed the cash.

Buffett used Berkshire to buy an insurance company. Insurers collect premiums today and pay claims later. In between, they hold huge piles of other people's money. Buffett called it float, and he invested it.

Since 1965, Berkshire's stock has grown at roughly twice the pace of the S&P 500.

He turned a dead textile mill into a machine that borrows from the future, at no interest, and buys great companies with it.

The lesson is simple, and almost nobody does it. Find the money that sits still, and put it to work.

8. Michael Burry: early looks exactly like wrong

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 152

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Burry or news segments on the 2008 crisis.
- Clips from The Big Short (Burry scenes) as an insert.
- Stills / cut-outs of Burry (a rare few exist), housing-bubble headlines, subprime charts.
- Graphic: US house prices (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The year Burry began shorting subprime (2005) and what a credit default swap is.
- Investor reaction and attempted withdrawals.
- Profit made for investors (cite Michael Lewis, The Big Short).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 2005, a neurologist turned fund manager named Michael Burry started reading something nobody else was reading. The fine print on mortgage bonds.

He saw it. Millions of loans to people who could never repay them, bundled and sold as safe.

There was no easy way to bet against it. So he asked the big banks to create one. Credit default swaps, insurance on those mortgage bonds. Banks were happy to sell it. They thought he was a fool.

For two years, he looked like one. The market kept climbing. His own investors got angry, and some tried to pull their money out.

Then the loans started to fail.

When the housing market broke in 2007 and 2008, Burry's bet made hundreds of millions of dollars for his fund's investors.

Being early feels identical to being wrong. The only difference is time, and you have to be able to afford the wait.

9. Bernard Arnault: how one man built LVMH

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 144

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Arnault (rare, so mostly press footage).
- Runway and boutique B-roll: Louis Vuitton, Dior, Tiffany. I can use your own or stock.
- Stills / cut-outs of Arnault, Dior and Vuitton archive images.
- Graphic: brand map of LVMH (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The 1984 Boussac purchase, what was kept and sold.
- How Arnault took control of LVMH (late 1980s).
- Tiffany acquisition (2021, about $15.8bn).
- Years he was ranked world's richest.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 1984, a young French businessman named Bernard Arnault bought a bankrupt textile company called Boussac. Nobody wanted it.

He didn't want the textiles either. Inside the wreckage was one thing he did want. Christian Dior.

He sold off almost everything else and kept the fashion house. Then he used it as a base. A few years later, two founders of Louis Vuitton and Moët Hennessy were locked in a fight. Arnault quietly bought shares, picked his moment, and took control of the combined company, LVMH.

Today it owns more than seventy brands, including Louis Vuitton, Dior and Tiffany, which it bought in 2021 for around fifteen billion dollars.

At times, Arnault has been ranked the richest person alive.

He never invented a handbag. He found the brands that people would pay more for with every passing year, and he bought the whole shelf.

10. The Hermès Birkin: how a bag became an asset

Pillar: Culture and Lifestyle | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 157

WHAT I NEED

- Footage of Hermès boutiques, artisans making bags (Hermès publishes craft films), Paris.
- Stills / cut-outs of Jane Birkin, Jean-Louis Dumas, a Birkin bag.
- Auction-house footage or screenshots (Christie's, Sotheby's).
- Pop-culture insert: a Sex and the City or Devil Wears Prada clip.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The 1984 flight story and who told it.
- Production volume and waiting-list practices (Hermès is cagey, so use reporting).
- Auction records and which sale (name year and house).
- Resale vs investment-return claims, which vary wildly. Cite or drop.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 1984, the actress Jane Birkin was on a flight from Paris to London. Her basket fell open. Her things spilled across the floor.

The man sitting next to her was Jean-Louis Dumas, the head of Hermès. She told him she could never find a bag with enough pockets.

He sketched one on the spot.

That bag is the Birkin, and it breaks every rule of retail. You can't just buy one, and you can't order one online. You build a history with a store, and wait. Each bag is made by a single craftsperson, from start to finish. And Hermès has long been accused of making fewer than people want.

And so a handbag sells at auction for more than most cars.

The brand didn't make a bag. It made a scarcity, and people will always pay for what they can't easily have.

The Birkin isn't expensive because it's leather. It's expensive because they said no.

11. Blockbuster turned down Netflix for $50 million

Pillar: Business and Power | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 131

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Reed Hastings telling the story.
- Footage of old Blockbuster stores, VHS and DVD, red envelopes.
- Stills / cut-outs of Hastings; the Netflix logo through time.
- Pop-culture insert: a classic video-store movie scene.
- Graphic: Blockbuster store count vs Netflix subscribers (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The 2000 offer: about $50m, and who was in the room.
- Blockbuster's peak size and the 2010 bankruptcy.
- Netflix streaming launch (2007).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In the year 2000, the founders of a small DVD-by-mail company flew to Dallas to meet the biggest name in video rental. Blockbuster had thousands of stores. Netflix was losing money.

The Netflix team offered to sell the company to Blockbuster for fifty million dollars.

Blockbuster passed. According to accounts of the meeting, they barely took it seriously.

Netflix kept going. In 2007, it started streaming. Blockbuster still counted on late fees, on stores and on the idea that customers wouldn't change.

By 2010, Blockbuster was bankrupt. Netflix is now worth hundreds of billions.

The people who killed Blockbuster didn't beat them in a store. They made the store pointless.

When a smaller competitor offers you a deal, they aren't asking for money. They're telling you where the market is going.

12. Elizabeth Holmes and the $9 billion lie (Theranos)

Pillar: Business and Power | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 148

WHAT I NEED

- Interview clips of Holmes (TED-style talks, news interviews).
- Footage from The Inventor (HBO documentary) or news coverage. Check clip rights.
- Stills / cut-outs of Holmes, the Theranos device, the board.
- Graphic: valuation timeline.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Founding age and year (19, 2003) and the $9bn valuation (2014).
- The 2015 Wall Street Journal reporting by John Carreyrou.
- The verdict (Jan 2022) and sentence (Nov 2022), counts and length.
- Stick to court findings, do not speculate.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 2003, a nineteen-year-old Stanford dropout named Elizabeth Holmes started a company called Theranos. Her claim was extraordinary. A few drops of blood from a finger prick, and hundreds of tests, instantly.

The pitch was perfect. The black turtleneck. The deep voice. The board full of former Cabinet members and generals.

By 2014, Theranos was valued at nine billion dollars.

There was just one problem. The technology didn't work.

In 2015, a Wall Street Journal reporter began asking questions. Employees spoke up. Investigations followed.

In January 2022, a jury convicted Holmes of defrauding investors. She was sentenced to more than eleven years in prison.

Theranos wasn't built on a machine. It was built on a story, and the investors were so busy listening that none of them asked to see the product.

In business, the most dangerous words are 'trust me'. The best ones are 'here's the data.'

13. WeWork: $47 billion to bankrupt

Pillar: Business and Power | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 142

WHAT I NEED

- Interview / news clips of Adam Neumann and SoftBank's Masayoshi Son.
- Footage of WeWork spaces (stock), the failed IPO news coverage.
- Stills / cut-outs of Neumann and Son.
- Graphic: valuation drop (I build it).
- Pop-culture insert: the WeCrashed series, if you have the clip.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- January 2019 valuation ($47bn).
- The IPO filing (Aug 2019) loss figures and governance points, including payment for the 'We' trademark.
- Neumann's exit terms.
- The November 2023 bankruptcy filing.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In January 2019, WeWork was worth forty-seven billion dollars. It rented office space and gave it a new name.

Adam Neumann, its founder, called it a technology company, a community, even a movement. The investor Masayoshi Son loved the story and wrote massive cheques.

Then, in August 2019, WeWork filed to go public, and investors saw the numbers for the first time. Billions in losses. A founder who had been paid millions for the 'We' name itself. Control that gave him almost unlimited power.

The IPO was cancelled. Within weeks, Neumann was out, with a huge exit package.

In November 2023, WeWork filed for bankruptcy.

The business was real. But it signed long, expensive leases and rented out short, cheap desks. Every time the market dipped, the maths broke.

A great story can raise money. Only a business model can keep it.

14. The weekend Lehman Brothers died

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 156

WHAT I NEED

- News footage from September 2008 (employees carrying boxes, trading floors, Treasury Dept).
- Clips from Margin Call and The Big Short as inserts.
- Stills / cut-outs of Dick Fuld, Hank Paulson, Ben Bernanke.
- Graphic: debt-to-equity ratio and Dow drop (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Filing date (15 Sept 2008) and assets (about $600bn+).
- Lehman's leverage ratio and how it compared.
- Bear Stearns rescue (March 2008) vs the decision on Lehman.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

On Monday, September 15th, 2008, Lehman Brothers filed for bankruptcy.

It was a hundred and fifty-eight years old. It had survived the Great Depression and two world wars. It held more than six hundred billion dollars in assets. It was the biggest bankruptcy in American history.

Lehman had borrowed enormous amounts of money to buy mortgage-backed assets. For every dollar it owned, it had borrowed about thirty. If those assets fell just a few percent, the company was wiped out.

Six months earlier, the government had helped rescue another bank, Bear Stearns. Lehman waited for the same rescue. It never came.

Within days, credit markets froze. Banks stopped lending to each other. The global financial crisis went from a problem to a disaster.

The scariest part wasn't greed or incompetence. It's that so many smart people believed the same thing at once: that the music wouldn't stop.

When everyone in the room agrees, check the exits.

15. Rockefeller and the day Standard Oil was broken up

Pillar: Business and Power | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 149

WHAT I NEED

- Archive photos and footage of John D. Rockefeller, oil fields, refineries (public domain).
- Stills / cut-outs: Rockefeller (public domain on Wikimedia Commons).
- The famous 'Octopus' cartoon (public domain).
- Graphic: family tree of Standard Oil's successors (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Standard Oil's refining share (often cited about 90% at its peak).
- The 1911 Supreme Court ruling and the number of successor companies (34).
- Rockefeller's wealth after the breakup.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

By 1880, one company controlled about ninety percent of the oil refined in America. That company was Standard Oil. The man behind it was John D. Rockefeller.

He didn't win by pumping the most oil. He won by controlling everything around it. The railroads, the pipelines, the barrels. He cut deals so good that rivals were crushed or forced to sell.

The press called Standard Oil 'the Octopus'. Congress passed laws to stop him. In 1911, the Supreme Court ordered the company broken into thirty-four pieces.

Here's the twist. Rockefeller didn't lose. He held shares in all of them, and as the pieces grew, his wealth grew even more. Many of those descendants are names you know today. Exxon. Mobil. Chevron.

The government broke the monopoly. It didn't break the man.

The real power in business isn't the biggest company. It's owning a piece of every company that matters.

16. The Hunt brothers tried to corner silver

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 155

WHAT I NEED

- Archive footage from 1979-80 (news, silver bars, Texas oil).
- Stills / cut-outs of Nelson Bunker Hunt and William Herbert Hunt (check licences).
- Graphic: silver price chart 1979-1980 (I build it).
- Pop-culture insert: a Trading Places clip (the commodity-trading comedy).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Silver price range (about $6 to about $50 per ounce).
- 'Silver Thursday', 27 March 1980.
- The aftermath: fines, trading bans and bankruptcy dates.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In the late 1970s, two Texas billionaires decided to do something almost impossible. They were going to take over the world's silver.

Nelson Bunker Hunt and his brother William Herbert Hunt were heirs to an oil fortune. They believed inflation would destroy paper money and that silver would be the safe place. So they began to buy it. Physical silver. Tons of it.

The price went from about six dollars an ounce to nearly fifty.

But rules changed. The exchange limited how much silver anyone could hold on credit. Banks began asking for cash. On Thursday, March 27th, 1980, the price collapsed. It became known as Silver Thursday.

The brothers owed hundreds of millions. They were banned from some markets, and by 1988, one of them was bankrupt.

They were right about inflation. They were wrong about leverage.

You can be right about the world, and still lose everything, if you borrowed to prove it.

17. George Soros: the man who broke the Bank of England

Pillar: Wealth and Capital | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 161

WHAT I NEED

- News footage of Black Wednesday (September 1992), the pound, Downing Street.
- Interview clips of Soros.
- Stills / cut-outs of Soros, Norman Lamont, John Major.
- Graphic: pound vs deutschmark and the ERM band (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The ERM and Britain's exit date (16 Sept 1992).
- Size of Soros's bet and estimated profit (about $1bn).
- What other funds and the Bank of England did.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In the early nineties, Britain had made a promise. The pound would stay at a fixed range against the German mark. The government said so, in public, again and again.

George Soros didn't believe it. His team looked at the numbers and saw an impossible position. To defend the pound, Britain would have to raise interest rates higher than its economy could stand.

So Soros bet against it, on a massive scale.

On September 16th, 1992, the Bank of England spent billions trying to hold the line. It raised interest rates twice in a single day. It didn't work. By evening, Britain pulled the pound out of the system.

Soros's funds made about a billion dollars, and the press called him the man who broke the Bank of England.

The government had made a promise the market could see it couldn't keep.

Whenever someone says 'we will defend this at any cost', the smartest money asks how much that cost is.

18. Steve Jobs: fired from his own company

Pillar: Ambition and People | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 150

WHAT I NEED

- Archive footage of Jobs: 1984 Macintosh launch, the 2005 Stanford speech, iPhone keynote.
- Footage of Pixar films, early Apple products.
- Stills / cut-outs of Jobs through the decades.
- Pop-culture insert: a Social Network or Steve Jobs film clip.

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- The 1985 board dispute and who was involved (John Sculley).
- NeXT and Pixar timelines.
- Apple's acquisition of NeXT (about $400m, completed Feb 1997).
- Apple becoming the most valuable company (2011).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In 1985, Apple's board stripped Steve Jobs of his role. He was thirty, and he'd been pushed out of the company he started in his parents' garage.

He later said it was awful. But it freed him.

He started a new computer company called NeXT. He bought a small graphics division from George Lucas and turned it into Pixar. In 1995, Pixar released Toy Story, the first fully computer-animated film.

Meanwhile, Apple was struggling. In late 1996, it bought NeXT for about four hundred million dollars, and Jobs came home.

Within two years, he'd introduced the iMac. Then the iPod. Then the iPhone. By 2011, Apple was the most valuable company in the world.

Jobs didn't just survive being fired. He used the exile to learn what he couldn't have learned inside.

Sometimes the worst thing that happens to you is the only thing that makes you what you become.

19. Rolex: the watch company nobody owns

Pillar: Culture and Lifestyle | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 158

WHAT I NEED

- Footage of Rolex watchmaking (Rolex publishes its own craft films), Geneva, boutique windows.
- Stills / cut-outs of Hans Wilsdorf, the Oyster, famous wearers.
- Auction clips (Paul Newman Daytona).
- Graphic: the ownership structure (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- Wilsdorf's founding history (London, 1905) and move to Geneva.
- The Hans Wilsdorf Foundation, how it owns Rolex (set up after his wife's death in 1944), and whether he had children.
- Production estimates (about one million watches a year) are estimates only.

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

Rolex is one of the most valuable brands on earth. But you can't buy shares in it. There is no stock. No IPO. No quarterly earnings call.

The reason goes back to a man named Hans Wilsdorf. He started the company in London in 1905, selling watches under a name he invented, and later moved the business to Geneva. He believed a wristwatch could be as reliable as a pocket watch, and he pushed for waterproof cases, which led to the Oyster.

In 1944, his wife died. They had no children. He set up a foundation and left his Rolex shares to it. Today, a charitable trust owns the company.

That means no shareholders demanding faster growth. No pressure to discount. No need to rush.

So Rolex can make fewer watches than people want. It can keep a design for decades.

Most companies chase the next quarter. Rolex plays a hundred-year game, because nobody can make it stop.

20. The PayPal Mafia

Pillar: Strategy and Intelligence | Length: 55-70s | Words: about 167

WHAT I NEED

- Footage and photos of the early PayPal team (the famous group photo exists, check licence).
- Interview clips of Thiel, Musk, Hoffman, Levchin.
- Logos for each company (Tesla, SpaceX, LinkedIn, YouTube, Yelp, Palantir).
- Graphic: the web of founders (I build it).

FACT-CHECK BEFORE YOU RECORD

- PayPal's formation (Confinity + X.com, 2000) and eBay sale (2002, about $1.5bn).
- Who founded which later company, and the exact claims.
- The term 'PayPal Mafia' origin (Fortune, 2007).

SCRIPT (VOICEOVER)

In October 2002, eBay bought a small payments company called PayPal for about one and a half billion dollars. For most people, that would be the end of the story.

For the people who built it, it was the start.

Peter Thiel became one of the first investors in Facebook and later co-founded Palantir. Reid Hoffman started LinkedIn. Three early employees started YouTube. Another started Yelp. Max Levchin started a lending company. Elon Musk, who'd merged his own company into PayPal, went on to Tesla and SpaceX.

A Fortune article in 2007 gave them a name. The PayPal Mafia.

Why did one small company produce so many founders? They were young, they were pushed hard, and they'd survived a brutal company with no safety net. They learned that you could build something huge from nothing, and then they did it again.

The best education in business isn't a course. It's a company that works you to the edge, and a group of people who survive it together.

Section 2: Movie edits

Simple, no effects. Clip, text, then a montage of clips and Pinterest pictures. You add the audio in TikTok after posting, so I export silent or with the original clip audio only.

The two types

	Type A: White-frame edit	Type B: Full-bleed edit
Look	White background. The clip sits in a framed window. Text sits above it and builds line by line. Then a white mood board of stills and short clips.	The clip fills the screen, often black and white. Small italic captions at the bottom. Then a montage of clips and pictures with the same look.
Text	Svenings, black, with one key word in cognac. Italic for small connecting words.	Svenings, light, small, wide spacing, bottom-centred. Subtitles of the dialogue only.
Reference	The three-ways Margin Call edit	The "I don't lose, I win" edit
Length	12-20 seconds	15-25 seconds
Montage	6-10 images or short clips, 0.5-1s each, on white	8-14 images or clips, 0.5-1s each, desaturated to match

Recipe for each edit

1. Pick one scene (5 to 25 seconds) and one core line.
2. Cut to the line. Add dialogue captions in Svenings.
3. Add the text hook (Type A) or leave the clip clean (Type B).
4. Montage: pull from the Pinterest set (pin_01 to pin_62) plus short clips. I choose the order for contrast and pace.
5. Export 1080x1920, 30 fps, no music. You add the sound in TikTok.

The 20-minute clip library

You said you can give me about 20 minutes of Succession (or similar) and I make five edits from it. Same approach for every source: you collect roughly 5-20 minutes of the strongest scenes; I mark the best 5-25 second sections and cut the edits. Suggested library:

Source	Collect (approx.)	Scenes to look for (from memory, verify)
Succession (HBO)	20 min	Logan: "I love you, but you are not serious people" (S1 finale); the "money wins" line; boardroom confrontations; Kendall and Roman scenes; a family dinner dispute.
Wall Street (1987)	6 min	Gekko speech to shareholders ("greed is good"); "lunch is for wimps"; the beach and office-tower scenes.
The Wolf of Wall Street	10 min	"Sell me this pen"; the boiler-room speech; the Matthew McConaughey lunch scene.
Margin Call	8 min	The late-night boardroom meeting; Tuld's speeches; the trading-floor scenes.
Industry (HBO)	8 min	Office and pitch scenes; trading floor; late-night work.
The Social Network	6 min	The deposition scenes; Sean Parker's

		"billion dollars" line.
Moneyball	5 min	Billy Beane and the owners; the "adapt or die" scene (check wording).
The Big Short	6 min	Burry at his desk; Mark Baum scenes; the crash scenes.
Billions	6 min	Axe and Chuck confrontations; the office scenes.
The Devil's Advocate	5 min	Milton and Kevin: "I win" scene.
Peaky Blinders	8 min	Tommy Shelby speeches and entrances.
Glengarry Glen Ross, American Psycho, Mad Men, House of Cards, The Godfather, Gatsby	3-5 min each	Sales speech; business-card scene; the Carousel pitch; Underwood asides; the "offer he can't refuse" scene; Gatsby's introduction.

20 edit plans

#	Type	Source	Scene to cut	Text / caption idea	Montage
1	A	Succession	Logan: "I love you, but you are not serious people."	Serious people don't ask. They buy.	Pin set: boardroom, tailoring, black cars.
2	A	Wall Street (1987)	Gekko's "greed is good" shareholders speech.	"Greed, for lack of a better word, is good."	Pin set: Wall Street, skyline, watches.
3	A	The Social Network	Sean Parker: a billion dollars.	"A million dollars isn't cool."	Pin set: tech offices, laptops, founders.
4	A	Moneyball	Beane in the owner's office ("adapt or die", check the wording).	Adapt or Perish.	Pin set: stats, stadium, pivot imagery; ties to our slogan.
5	A	Margin Call	Tuld on cycles and who gets out first.	There are only three ways... (use a different line from the already-viral one).	Pin set: skylines, trading floor.
6	A	The Wolf of Wall Street	"Sell me this pen."	Create the need.	Pin set: pens, watches, cars, offices.
7	A	Succession	"Money wins."	Money wins. Everything else is a speech.	Pin set: private jets, black cars, villas.
8	A	Industry	Harper and Eric in a tense office scene.	Everyone is replaceable. Be the exception.	Pin set: late-night offices, glass towers.
9	A	The Big Short	Burry or Baum at the desk.	Early looks exactly like wrong.	Pin set: charts, housing, calm interiors.
10	A	Billions	Axe in a power scene.	Never negotiate from need.	Pin set: private offices, helicopters.
11	B	The Devil's Advocate	Pacino and Reeves: "I win. That's what I do."	Captions only (dialogue).	Black and white montage: cars, suits, architecture.
12	B	Peaky Blinders	Tommy Shelby speech / entrance.	Captions only.	Black and white montage: tailoring, cars, streets.
13	B	American Psycho	The business-card scene.	Captions only.	Montage: stationery, tailoring,

					glass buildings.
14	B	The Godfather	"An offer he can't refuse."	Captions only.	Montage: dark rooms, watches, old cars.
15	B	Glengarry Glen Ross	"Always be closing" / "coffee is for closers" speech.	Captions only.	Montage: sales floors, suits, handshakes.
16	B	Mad Men	Draper's Carousel pitch.	Captions only.	Montage: vintage ads, interiors, cars.
17	B	Succession	Logan or Kendall in a short, cold line.	Captions only.	Montage: dark interiors, helicopters, city night.
18	B	The Wolf of Wall Street	Belfort's "I'm not leaving" speech.	Captions only.	Montage: cars, yachts, boardrooms.
19	B	House of Cards	Underwood to camera.	Captions only.	Montage: Washington, black cars, corridors.
20	B	The Great Gatsby	Gatsby's introduction.	Captions only.	Montage: parties, champagne, architecture.

Caption note: dialogue captions must match the actual line. Check each against the clip. Quotes in text hooks need attribution to the character or film.

Reuse warning: the Margin Call "three ways" edit is already circulating. If you use that scene, change the framing so it does not read as a copy.

Section 3: Lifestyle montages

Format: 15-25 seconds, 8-14 clips of 1.5-3 seconds each, on a single mood. No dialogue. Text only at the start and end. You add the sound in TikTok.

Where the clips come from (the honest answer)

Source	Cost	Risk	Notes
Your own footage	Free-£	None	Car meets and Cars and Coffee, hotel lobbies, airport lounges, marinas, dealerships (ask), watch boutiques. Best long term.
Free stock (Pexels, Pixabay, Coverr, Mixkit)	Free	Low	Check each licence. Looks generic; use as seasoning.
Paid stock (Storyblocks, Artgrid, Pond5, Envato)	Monthly	Low	Better look and luxury categories. Beyond your starting budget.
Press kits and brand media pages	Free	Low with permission	Car makers, hotels, yacht brokers and watch brands release footage. Ask first.
AI-generated clips	Credits	Medium	Higgsfield is connected here and can generate video. Costs credits and needs your OK. TikTok requires labelling realistic AI content. Best for impossible shots (jets, villas).
Reposted creator footage	Free	High	What many accounts do. Copyright strikes, muted or removed videos, and it is not your content.

Brand rule

Our content is faceless. Present these as aspiration and mood, not "my life". Do not imply the footage is yours if it is stock, AI or someone else's. That protects trust when the brand starts making commercial promises.

Ten concepts

6. Private jet life: cabins, tarmac, laptops at altitude.
7. Monaco weekend: harbour, casino, supercars.
8. Alpine winter: chalets, ski runs, firelight.
9. Old money garage: classic cars, leather, tools.
10. Black car: chauffeurs, hotel entrances, rain.
11. Watch and tailoring: details, cufflinks, fabrics.
12. The villa: infinity pools, terraces, interiors.
13. Yacht day: marinas, decks, tenders.
14. City at night: towers, offices, taxis.
15. Boardroom to runway: suits, fashion week, glass lobbies.

What I need

- At least 25 clips per concept (to keep the best 10), landscape or vertical, 2-10 seconds each.

- Consistent colour, so the mood board looks cohesive. I can grade to match.
- Tell me which are your own or licensed, so I can log them.

Section 4: Slideshows

Format: 7-10 slides. Slide 1 is a handwritten quote on paper; slides 2-9 are the pictures; the last slide is another quote. The pictures use the white-canvas frame.

Image workflow (confirmed)

- Canvas 1080 x 2340, white. Photo frame 1080 x 834, centred slightly above the middle (same as batch 1).
- Subject-aware: cars, people and key objects are centred and kept whole. If a subject is too wide, I extend the edges rather than cut it.
- Low-quality images are upscaled and lightly sharpened. Resampling only; it cannot add true detail.
- Batch 2 (24 new pins) is delivered as pin_39 to pin_62.

Twelve themed sets

Set	Image mix	Handwritten quote idea
Old Money Garage	Cars, leather, tools	"No risk, no Porsche."
The House	Interiors, tapestries, terraces	"Build the room you want to be taken seriously in."
Black Car Hours	Chauffeurs, luggage, night	"Late is a luxury only the early can afford."
Jet Hours	Cabins, laptops, tarmac	"Work where others holiday."
Alpine	Chalets, ski, firelight	"Silence is the new status."
Monaco	Harbour, supercars, boats	"The House always wins."
Tailoring	Suits, loafers, cufflinks	"Dress for the meeting after the meeting."
Boardroom	Offices, tables, towers	"Adapt or Perish."
Watches	Details, wrists, boutiques	"Time is the only budget that matters."
Quiet Luxury	Neutrals, fabrics, design	"If you have to announce it..."
Garden Estate	Gardens, stonework, estates	"Think in decades."
The Rooms	Hotels, lobbies, libraries	"Be in the room where it is decided."

Quote lines are my originals. Check they are not already someone's trademarked slogan before heavy use.

Section 5: The Brief (proposed)

This is my proposal for the fifth format. Keep it, change it or drop it. It is cheap to make and fills the weekly schedule.

Structure

Time	Beat
0-3s	Hook: one number or one claim
3-15s	What happened
15-25s	Why it matters
25-30s	One line, then the SR end card

Needs

- One clip or graphic. I can build the graphic. You supply news clips if you want them.
- Voiceover (optional): 60 to 90 words.
- A source link for every claim.

Twelve starter topics (to research, not facts)

- What a private jet really costs per hour.
- The biggest acquisition of the month.
- An IPO that surprised people.
- The company that missed its quarter, and why.
- A CEO leaving and what it signals.
- A famous brand changing its logo and why.
- The price of a Birkin versus gold.
- How a rate decision hits your savings.
- The most expensive watch sale of the year.
- A merger that regulators blocked.
- A startup that raised a huge round.
- A rivalry that escalated this week.

Section 6: Fonts, licences and specs

Font	Use	Licence status
Svenings (Sveningsson)	Main font for edits, captions and slideshow text	Unknown. Check the licence; many free fonts are personal-use only.
Baskervville	Website, headings, long editorial text	Open font (SIL OFL, Google Fonts). Free for commercial use.
Alte Haas Grotesk	Utility text, UI, captions if needed	Free font. Check licence for commercial use.
Neue Haas Grotesk Display Round 65 Medium (trial)	Not used yet	TRIAL file. Trial fonts are normally licensed for testing only. Buy a licence before using it on public content.

Technical specs

- Video: 1080 x 1920, 30 fps, H.264 MP4. Safe margins: 130 px top, 330 px bottom, 90 px each side (TikTok interface covers these).
- Slideshow images: 1080 x 2340 JPEG, quality 95.
- Palette (Midnight & Cognac): Midnight #0D1B2E, Parchment #F1ECE0, Silver #B9B8B2, Cognac #8A4B2D, Ink #0D0D0D.
- Cross-posting: export a clean file without any platform watermark and upload that to each platform.

Section 7: Asset checklist

What	From	Format	For
Voiceover audio	You (ElevenLabs)	mp3 or wav	Explainers
Interview and news clips	You	mp4, short clips	Explainers
Movie and series clips	You	mp4 with timestamps	Movie edits
Pinterest pictures	You (done for 62)	zip	Slideshows, montages
Lifestyle footage	You, stock, or AI (with your OK)	mp4	Montages
Cut-out stills	Me (Wikimedia and press kits)	png	Explainers
Graphics and charts	Me	png / mp4	Explainers, Brief
Final logo	Later redesign	svg / png	End card
Fonts	Done (check licences)	ttf / otf	All

Order I would build in

- 1. Two movie edits (fastest, tests the pipeline).
- 2. Five slideshows from the 62 pictures.
- 3. One explainer end-to-end (suggest Scale AI).
- 4. First lifestyle montage.
- 5. Review views and watch time, then scale what works.